DAY 8 - BEGINNER

Dates, Missing Values & Duplicates

Primary tool: Google Sheets

What you are learning

Dates as values, blanks vs zero, duplicate detection and documentation.

Learning objectives

- Identify missing values
- Detect duplicates
- Standardize dates
- Document cleaning decisions

Worked practical

Create a small data-quality log showing issue type, count, decision and affected field.

Source / Input	Method	Output / Check
Raw data	Apply the lesson skill	Result linked to source
Change one input	Recalculate / rerun	Confirm expected change
Control total / test	Validate	Explain the result

Guided practice

1. Recreate the lesson idea on a small example.
2. Change inputs and predict the result before recalculating.
3. Complete the supplied independent dataset in the required tool.
4. Create a control check or reconciliation.
5. Explain the result in ordinary language.

AI coaching

Ask AI to challenge your cleaning decision: 'What could go wrong if I replace blanks with zero?'

AI discipline

Attempt first. Use AI for explanation, hints, debugging, critique, test cases and mock questioning. Never submit output you cannot explain and independently verify.

Independent exercise

Audit and clean a registration dataset.

Common failure modes

- Wrong grain or key.
- Formula/query/code answers a different question.
- Missing or unmatched records are silently ignored.
- Findings are not reconciled to the numbers.
- AI-generated logic is accepted without testing.

Mastery gate

[ ] I can reproduce the method without copying.
[ ] I can trace the result to the source.
[ ] I have a QA/control check.
[ ] I can explain a limitation.
[ ] I can answer an assessor's follow-up question without asking AI.